

Instructions for Administration:

5 Months Old

Note Ensure to wash your hands before handling the child and to handle the child gently.

Definitions

Plane: In reference to items requiring holding a body part on the same plane as another, this refers to being level to.

Prone Position: The prone position refers to lying horizontally with the face and torso facing down. The infant lies with knees drawn up under the abdomen with pelvis high. Head is turned to one side.

Supine Position: The supine position refers to lying horizontally with the face and torso facing up.

Ventral Suspension: The baby is placed in prone position and suspended in the air by a hand placed under the chest. The head hangs down with some flexion of elbows and knees.

1.1 Gross Motor

Notes If the child does not perform the gross motor item for their age, but performs a more advanced gross motor item, then the item specific for their age is considered normal.

The first step towards the development of locomotion is the development of head control, that is, the ability to support the head in all positions of the body. The steps in this are observed in three situations: in ventral suspension, in prone position, and in supine position.

1.1.17	In sitting position, holds head up well consistently	Age: 4 - 5 months
Materials	Padded Surface	
Instructions	Sit the infant on a padded surface on the floor and keep their position steady. Provide trunk support by holding their forearms. 	
Response	Holds head up well, and constantly for at least two minutes.	
Grading	Present < 2 minutes Few seconds Poor Attempt	

1.1.18	Full head control on pull to sitting	Age: 5 months
Materials	Padded Surface	
Instructions	With the infant in supine position, grasp the hands and pull the infant towards a sitting position. 	
Response	The infant shows head control, no head lag.	
Grading	Present Mild Head Lag Tries to lift head No attempt	

1.2 Fine Motor Items

Note If the child does not perform the fine motor item for their age, but performs a more advanced fine motor item, then the item specific for their age is considered normal.

1.2.3	Hand posture	Age: 3 - 5 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	Observe the infant when awake and alert, and at rest. Note the posture of the hands. 	
Response	Hands should be open most of the time.	
Grading	Present Lightly fisted Semi-clenched Tightly clenched	

1.2.6	Reaches for, and grasps an object in front	Age: 5 months
Materials	Attractive Toy, Padded Surface	
Instructions	Sit the infant or place in supine position on a padded surface on the floor. Place a brightly coloured toy about 20-25cm directly in front of the infant, within their reach. Hold one hand and watch to see if the infant reaches with the other. Encourage as needed. Test both hands separately. 	
Response	Observe if the infant can reach and grasp the object with each hand.	
Grading	Present With difficulty Attempts No attempt	

1.3 Vision Items

1.3.9	Watches moving adult from 3 metres	Age: 3 - 11 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	Stand in front of the infant at a distance of three metres and draw their attention. Move along an arc around the visual field of the infant and observe if the eyes move to track the moving adult. If no response, keep coming closer and observe the distance at which the infant's visual attention is engaged.	
Response	Infant watches moving adult from 3 metres.	
Grading	Present From 2m From 1m From <1m	

1.3.10	Fixates on a 2.5cm Block from 30cm	Age: 5 months
Materials	1 Yellow Block, Green Cloth If no response to Block: Red Ball on String, Red Woolly Ball, Compact Mirror, Torch	
Instructions	The infant is seated supported upright in the caregiver's lap at a table. Lay the green cloth on the table. Show a yellow block to the infant and say "Ooh! Look at this beautiful thing". Then, place the block on one side of the table keeping the gaze of the infant on the block. Then, sweep your hand across the table holding the block, and release it at some point. Observe whether the infant fixates their gaze on the released block. If no response, test with the spinning 6cm spinning red ball on a string; then with the 12.5cm red woolly ball; then with a reflecting object at a distance of 25 cm; then with the reflecting object at a closer distance. 	
Response	Infant fixates gaze on block from 30cm.	
Grading	Present Fixes/follows the 6cm spinning red ball Fixes/follows the 12.5cm spinning woolly ball Fixes/follows reflecting object	

1.4 Hearing Items

Note Soft whisper - 10 to 25 db; conversational speech - 25 to 55 db; crying baby - 55 to 65 db; rattle - 60 to 80db.

1.4.7	Response to rattle	Age: 4 - 6 months
1.4.8	Response to Voice	Age: 4 - 6 months
Materials	Rattle, Assistant	
Instructions	Sit the infant on the caregiver's lap with head in the midline. The auditory stimulus is: (a) presented at the ear level, (b) about 45 cm from the ear, (c) out of the line of vision Shake the rattle gently. Test the right ear, then the left ear. Call the infant in a soft. Test the right ear, then the left ear.  	
Response	The infant turns head towards the side from which the sound comes without actual location of the sound source / shifts eye / alerts / changes facial expression. The best response to any one of the two sound sources is taken as normal.	
Grading	Present Questionable To loud rattle/voice only No response	

1.5 Expressive Language Item

Note This domain relies primarily on observation of infant vocalisations during the session:

- The examiner has to be vigilant about recording all infant vocalisations during the entire assessment so that none are missed.
- Interact and speak with the child to encourage vocalisations.
- If no vocalisations are made throughout the assessment, ask the caregiver if this is typical as it is not uncommon for young children to behave differently in new and unfamiliar situations. Document specific examples of vocalisations reported by the caregiver on the record form.

1.5.5	Loud vocalisations	Age: 5 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	The infant will vocalise. The infant may also blow saliva from the mouth to make 'raspberries' spontaneously.	
Response	Note the frequency that the infant vocalises loudly.	
Grading	Present Occasional Seldom No Sounds	

1.6 Cognition Item

1.6.10	Looks at the rattle they are holding and plays with it	Age: 4 - 5 months
Materials	Rattle	
Instructions	Sit the infant upright on the caregiver's lap. Hold the rattle about 20-25cm from the infant. Shake it gently to attract attention and encourage the infant to reach. If the infant does not reach for the rattle, place it in their hands so that they play with it.	
Response	Observe if the infant looks at the rattle and plays with it, e.g., chewing or shaking, for several moments.	
Grading	Present Momentarily Looking present but no playing No looking but playing OR No looking or playing	

1.7 Behaviour Items

Note It is essential the examiner scores the Behaviour items based on their observations and caregiver report regarding sleep. Observe and record the child's behaviour according to the activities listed under this domain.

1.7.6	Sleep/awake rhythm	Age: 1 - 11 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	Ask the caregiver about the infant's sleep patterns.	
Response	Score according to caregiver's recall. Over the first 3 months of life the total amount of sleep declines little, but the cycles are longer so that, by the age of 3 months, 70% of infants are sleeping right through the night. By 6 months, 80% of infants sleep through the night, but there are still 10% waking every night by the age of 1 year. By this age, the great majority of infants have established a stable pattern of sleep and wakefulness with a long sleep at night and a nap in the morning and afternoon. Mild, moderate and severe grades of response are: occasional disturbance, considerable disturbance, and constant problem. Either the infant is sleeping too much or is awake for longer periods of time.	
Grading	Normal sleep patterns Occasional disturbance Considerable disturbance Constant problems	

1.7.7	Displays positive affect most of the time	Age: 1 - 11 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	Note the infant's affect.	
Response	The grading is done according to the degree of negative affect displayed during the assessment. Positive affect comprises of smiling, laughing, sound making that is perceived as the expression of excitement, happiness or pleasure. Negative affect includes fussing, pouting, whining, crying, vocal or physical expressions of anger.	
Grading	Displays positive affect Sometimes negative Mostly negative Constantly negative	

1.7.8	Displays normal periods of quietness	Age: 3 - 11 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	This item tests the child's quietness. Few children are so quiet that they are very unresponsive.	
Response	The infant is quiet, responsive, not restless.	
Grading	Displays normal periods of quietness Placid/Quiet Unusually Quiet Extremely Quiet	

1.7.9	Displays responsiveness to surroundings	Age: 3 - 11 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	Observe if infant engages in visual, auditory, oral, or physical exploration. For example, trying to touch or hold objects.	
Response	Degree of responsiveness is noted. A curiosity towards new stimuli within the environment is normal.	
Grading	Present Most of the time Infrequent Never	

1.7.10	Good eye contact	Age: 3 - 11 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	Note the frequency of eye contact the infant makes with the examiner.	
Response	The infant should be making eye contact with persons interacting with them.	
Grading	Present Most of the time Infrequent Never	

1.8 Seizure Item

1.8.3	Seizures (provoked or unprovoked)	Age: 3 - 5 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	Ask caregiver or check medical records to determine whether infant has ever experienced a seizure. Seizures are manifestations of neuronal injury due to excessive electrical activity in the brain. Any disturbance in the brain may cause seizures, which may be single or repetitive, and involves a sudden change in behaviour.	
Response	Consider typical if the infant has not had a provoked or unprovoked seizure.	
Grading	No seizures (provoked or unprovoked) ≥ Once, but none in the past month ≥ Once, also in the past month > Once, also in the past week	